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CSS
The Definitive Guide
Web Layout and Presentation



Eric A. Meyer
& Estelle Weyl

Estelle Weyl

I would like to acknowledge everyone who has worked to make CSS what it is today and all those who have helped improve diversity and inclusion in tech.

Many people work tirelessly with browser vendors and developers in writing the CSS specifications. Without the members of the CSS Working Group—past, current, and future—we would have no specifications, no standards, and no cross-browser compatibility. I am in awe of the thought process that goes into every CSS property and value added to, and omitted from, the specification. People like Tab Atkins, Elika Etimad, Dave Baron, Léonie Watson, and Greg Whitworth not only work on the specification, but also take their time to answer questions and explain nuances to the broader CSS public, notably me.

I also acknowledge all those who, whether they participate in the CSS Working Group or not, dive deep into CSS features and help translate the spec for the rest of us, including Sarah Drasner, Val Head, Sara Souidan, Chris Coyier, Jen Simmons, and Rachel Andrew. In addition, I thank the people who create tools that make all CSS developers' lives easier, especially Alexis Deveria for creating and maintaining the Can I Use tool (*https://caniuse.com*).

I also appreciate all those who have contributed their time and effort to improve diversity and inclusion in all sectors of the developer community. Yes, CSS is awesome. But it's important to work with great people in a great community.

When I attended my first tech conference in 2007, the lineup was 93% male and 100% white. The audience had slightly less gender diversity and only slightly more ethnic diversity. I had picked that conference because the lineup was more diverse than most: it actually had a woman on it. Looking around the room, I knew things needed to change, and I realized it was something I needed to do. What I didn't realize then was how many unsung heroes I would meet over the next 10 years working for diversity and inclusion in all areas of the tech sector and life in general.

There are too many people—who work tirelessly, quietly, and often with little or no recognition—to name them all, but I would like to highlight some. I cannot express how much of a positive impact people like Erica Stanley of Women Who Code Atlanta, Carina Zona of Callback Women, and Jenn Mei Wu of Oakland Maker Space have had. Groups like The Last Mile, Black Girls Code, Girls Incorporated, Sisters Code, and so many others inspired me to create a Feeding the Diversity Pipeline list (*http://www.standardista.com/feeding-the-diversity-pipeline*) to help ensure that the path to a career in web development is not only for those with privilege.

Thank you to all of you. Thank you to everyone. Because of your efforts, more has been done than I ever could have imagined sitting in that conference 10 years ago.

San Francisco, CA
February 14, 2023

CHAPTER 1
CSS Fundamentals

Cascading Style Sheets (*CSS*), a powerful programming language that transforms the presentation of a document or a collection of documents, has spread to nearly every corner of the web as well as many ostensibly nonweb environments. For example, embedded-device displays often use CSS to style their user interfaces, many RSS clients let you apply CSS to feeds and feed entries, and some instant message clients use CSS to format chat windows. Aspects of CSS can be found in the syntax used by JavaScript (JS) frameworks and even in JS itself. It's everywhere!

A Brief History of (Web) Style

CSS was first proposed in 1994, just as the web was beginning to really catch on. At the time, browsers gave all sorts of styling power to the user—the presentation preferences in NCSA Mosaic, for example, permitted the user to define each element's font family, size, and color. None of this was available to document authors; all they could do was mark a piece of content as a paragraph, as a heading of some level, as preformatted text, or one of a dozen other element types. If a user configured their browser to make all level-one headings tiny and pink and all level-six headings huge and red, well, that was their lookout.

It was into this milieu that CSS was introduced. Its goal was to provide a simple, declarative styling language that was flexible for web page authors and, most importantly, provided styling power to authors and users alike. By means of the *cascade*, these styles could be combined and prioritized so that both site authors and readers had a say—though readers always had the last say.

Work quickly advanced, and by late 1996, CSS1 was finished. While the newly established CSS Working Group moved forward with CSS2, browsers struggled to implement CSS1 in an interoperable way. Although each piece of CSS was fairly simple on its own, the combination of those pieces created some surprisingly complex behaviors. Unfortunate missteps also occurred, such as the infamous discrepancy in box model implementations. These

problems threatened to derail CSS altogether, but fortunately some clever proposals were implemented, and browsers began to harmonize. Within a few years, thanks to increasing interoperability and high-profile developments such as the CSS-based redesign of *Wired* magazine and the CSS Zen Garden, CSS began to catch on.

Before all that happened, though, the CSS Working Group had finalized the CSS2 specification in early 1998. Once CSS2 was finished, work immediately began on CSS3, as well as a clarified version of CSS2 called CSS2.1. In keeping with the spirit of the times, what was initially coined *CSS3* was constructed as a series of (theoretically) standalone modules instead of a single monolithic specification. This approach reflected the then-active XHTML specification, which was split into modules for similar reasons.

The rationale for modularizing CSS was that each module could be worked on at its own pace, and particularly critical (or popular) modules could be advanced along the World Wide Web Consortium's (W3C's) progress track without being held up by others. Indeed, this has turned out to be the case. By early 2012, three CSS Level 3 modules (along with CSS1 and CSS 2.1) had reached full Recommendation status—CSS Color Level 3, CSS Namespaces, and Selectors Level 3. At that same time, seven modules were at Candidate Recommendation status, and several dozen others were in various stages of Working Draft-ness. Under the old approach, colors, selectors, and namespaces would have had to wait for every other part of the specification to be done or cut before they could be part of a completed specification. Thanks to modularization, they didn't have to wait.

So while we can't really point to a single tome and say, "This is CSS," we can talk of features by the module name under which they are introduced. The flexibility permitted by modules more than makes up for the semantic awkwardness they sometimes create. (If you want something approximating a single monolithic specification, the CSS Working Group publishes yearly "Snapshot" documents.)

With that established, we're ready to start understanding CSS. Let's start by covering the basics of what goes inside a stylesheet.

Stylesheet Contents

Inside a stylesheet, you'll find a number of *rules* that look a little something like this:

```
h1 {color: maroon;}
body {background: yellow;}
```

Styles such as these make up the bulk of any stylesheet—simple or complex, short or long. But which parts are which, and what do they represent?

Rule Structure

To illustrate the concept of rules in more detail, let's break down the structure.

Each *rule* has two fundamental parts: the selector and the declaration block. The declaration block is composed of one or more declarations, and each declaration is a pairing of a

property and a value. Every stylesheet is made up of a series of these rules. Figure 1-1 shows the parts of a rule.

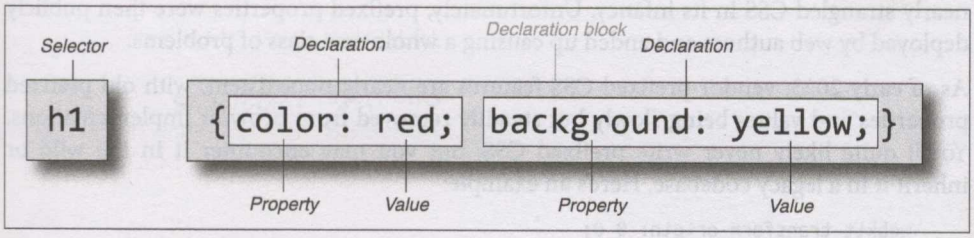


Figure 1-1. The structure of a rule

The *selector*, shown on the left side of the rule, defines which piece of the document will be selected for styling. In Figure 1-1, `<h1>` (heading level 1) elements are selected. If the selector were `p`, then all `<p>` (paragraph) elements would be selected.

The right side of the rule contains the *declaration block*, which is made up of one or more declarations. Each *declaration* is a combination of a CSS *property* and a *value* of that property. In Figure 1-1, the declaration block contains two declarations. The first states that this rule will cause parts of the document to have a `color` of `red`, and the second states that part of the document will have a `background` of `yellow`. So, all of the `<h1>` elements in the document (defined by the selector) will be styled in red text with a yellow background.

Vendor Prefixing

Sometimes you'll see pieces of CSS with hyphens and labels in front of them, like this: `-o-border-image`. These *vendor prefixes* were a way for browser vendors to mark properties, values, or other bits of CSS as being experimental or proprietary (or both). As of early 2023, a few vendor prefixes are in the wild, with the most common shown in Table 1-1.

Table 1-1. Some common vendor prefixes

Prefix	Vendor
`-epub-`	International Digital Publishing Forum ePub format
`-moz-`	Gecko-based browsers (e.g., Mozilla Firefox)
`-ms-`	Microsoft Internet Explorer
`-o-`	Opera-based browsers
`-webkit-`	WebKit-based browsers (e.g., Apple Safari and Google Chrome)

As Table 1-1 indicates, the generally accepted format of a vendor prefix is a hyphen, a label, and a hyphen, although a few prefixes erroneously omit the first hyphen.

The uses and abuses of vendor prefixes are long, tortuous, and beyond the scope of this book. Suffice to say that they started out as a way for vendors to test out new features, thus

General Election

Tuesday, November 3, 2026

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Return your ballot as soon as you receive it.

Vote-by-mail early voting period opens October 5, 2026.

Polls are open from 7:00 a.m. to 8:00 p.m. on November 3, 2026, Election Day!

CALIFORNIA TRUSTED INFO

Every registered voter in California will receive a ballot by mail.

Ballots are mailed on or before October 5.

Ballots can be voted and returned as soon as they are received.

Ballot drop boxes open October 6.

In-person voting options will be available in all counties.



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Certificate of Correctness

I, Shirley N. Weber, Secretary of State of the State of California, do hereby certify that the information included herein will be submitted to the electors of the State of California at the General Election to be held throughout the State on November 3, 2026, and that this guide has been correctly prepared in accordance with the law. Witness my hand and the Great Seal of the State in Sacramento, California, this 10th day of August, 2026.

Shirley N. Weber, Ph.D.
Secretary of State

General Election

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Official Voter Information Guide

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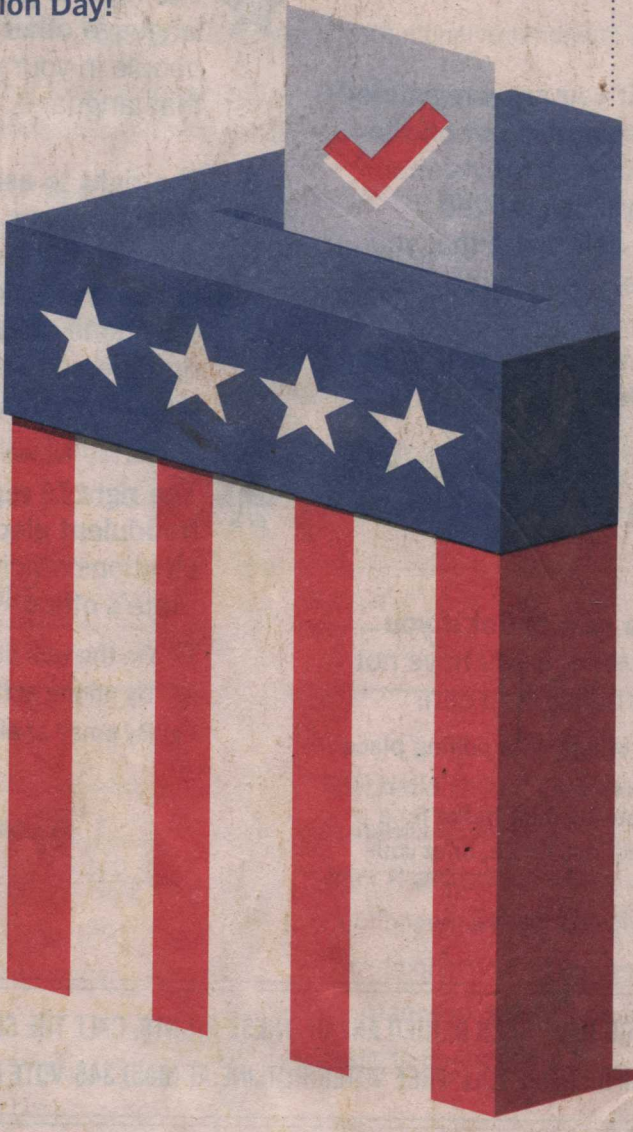
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Shirley N. Weber, Ph.D.
Secretary of State

measure solely because it adds or amends one or more of the sections of the Government Code, Health and Safety Code, or Corporations Code added or amended by this measure. In the event this measure receives a greater number of affirmative votes than a measure deemed to be in conflict with it, the provisions of this measure shall prevail in their entirety, and the other measure or measures shall be null and void.

PROPOSITION 45

This initiative measure is submitted to the people in accordance with the provisions of Section 8 of Article II of the California Constitution.

This initiative measure adds sections to the Public Resources Code; therefore, new provisions proposed to be added are printed in *italic type* to indicate that they are new.

PROPOSED LAW

SECTION 1. Chapter 1.5 (commencing with Section 21010) is added to Division 13 of the Public Resources Code, to read:

CHAPTER 1.5. BUILDING AN AFFORDABLE CALIFORNIA ACT

Article 1. Title, Findings and Declarations, and Purpose

21010. Title

This chapter shall be known, and may be cited, as the Building an Affordable California Act.

21011. Findings and Declarations

The people of the State of California hereby find and declare all of the following:

(a) California's outdated system for approving essential projects is too slow, too bureaucratic, and too costly. Essential projects like clean water, clean energy, hospitals, affordable housing, roads, wildfire prevention, schools, public safety, and other infrastructure improvements are being delayed or blocked by unnecessary red tape, bureaucratic delays, and excessive lawsuits.

(b) These delays substantially increase the cost of living for all Californians. Research shows that permitting delays alone add tens of thousands of dollars to the price of a new home, driving up rents and mortgages for homeowners and renters. Similar red tape adds billions of dollars to the cost of building hospitals, water infrastructure, roads, bridges, clean energy, schools, broadband, and wildfire mitigation projects, costs ultimately passed on to consumers and taxpayers.

(c) California's permitting laws were written more than 50 years ago, before today's modern environmental laws were in place. That outdated system now works against the state's environmental and public health goals by slowing down or blocking essential projects that would reduce air pollution, lower greenhouse gas emissions, safeguard water supplies, protect communities from wildfire, and preserve wildlife and the environment.

(d) The act will modernize and streamline state law to cut bureaucratic red tape and unnecessary delays, limit frivolous lawsuits that block essential projects while allowing public agencies and essential project applicants to continue sharing the burden of defending against those suits, and speed up delivery of projects Californians rely on every day.

(e) Every year of delay means Californians wait longer and pay more for the things they need most. The act applies to the state's most essential projects, including:

(1) Clean drinking water and secure water supplies for communities across the state.

(2) Safe, modern hospitals and clinics to ensure access to affordable health care.

(3) Clean energy and reliable electricity to reduce energy bills and fight climate change.

(4) Housing of all types in order to make housing more affordable for families struggling with skyrocketing rents and mortgages as well as vulnerable senior populations.

(5) Roads, bridges, and transit to cut traffic congestion and improve public safety.

(6) Wildfire prevention and resilience projects to protect lives, homes, and natural resources.

(7) Safe, modernized public schools and educational facilities for students and educators.

(8) Broadband and telecommunications infrastructure to connect underserved communities and expand opportunity.

(f) By speeding up these essential projects, the act will make California more affordable and lower the cost of housing, energy, electricity, health care, and other necessities, while also reducing taxpayer costs for public works projects.

(g) The act will also jump-start projects that create well-paying jobs and put tens of thousands of Californians to work, especially in construction, clean energy, and infrastructure, helping grow California's economy when it is needed most.

(h) Importantly, the act maintains state and federal clean air, clean water, and environmental protection laws, including the Endangered Species Act, the Safe Drinking Water Act, the federal Toxic Substances Control Act, the federal Clean Water Act, the Clean Air Act, the federal Environmental Quality Improvement Act, the California Global Warming Solutions Act, the California Coastal Act, and the federal Resource Conservation and Recovery Act. This chapter will help build the projects needed to make California more affordable, without repealing these laws that keep families and the environment safe.

(i) We can and must build an affordable California.

21012. Statement of Purpose

The purpose of this chapter is to make California more affordable by streamlining and speeding approval of essential projects, reducing costs for families and taxpayers, improving quality of life, creating good jobs, and maintaining California's strongest-in-the-world environmental protections.

Article 2. Application of Chapter and Interaction with Other Laws

21013. Projects Subject to this Chapter

This chapter applies only to essential housing projects, essential clean energy projects, essential water projects, essential public health projects, essential public safety projects, essential broadband internet access projects, essential education facility projects, and essential transportation projects that the people of California hereby declare to be critical to their quality of life and affordability in this state.

21014. Application of Chapter

(a) This chapter does not diminish the authority of any public agency to approve or disapprove an essential project. No outcomes on any proposed essential project are preordained by this chapter.

(b) This chapter does not exempt any essential project from environmental review under this division or any other law. This chapter establishes clear timelines and other procedures for review under this division and administrative permit review for essential projects.

(c) Except as otherwise provided in this chapter, this chapter shall apply to review and processing of any and every application or approval for an essential project and its accompanying land use entitlements, including, without limitation, discretionary adjudicative and legislative land use entitlements triggering programmatic, plan-level, or project-level environmental review under this division.

(d) This chapter shall apply to all public agencies.

(e) (1) To the extent a conflict exists between this chapter and any other law, this chapter shall control. Notwithstanding anything to the contrary, this chapter shall not abrogate or limit any otherwise applicable statutory or categorical exemption from this division.

(2) Notwithstanding Section 21100 or any other law, the provisions of this chapter shall control and supersede any conflicting requirement for environmental review of an essential project, and any accompanying permit review. No provision of Section 21100 or any other law shall invalidate or limit the application of this chapter to an essential project.

(f) (1) An application for an essential project that was submitted to a public agency before the effective date of this chapter, and that has not yet received final approval before that date, may be withdrawn and resubmitted after the effective date of this chapter.

(2) An application for an essential project that is withdrawn and resubmitted as provided in paragraph (1) can be reviewed and approved pursuant to the provisions of this chapter.

(3) Essential housing projects with applications withdrawn and resubmitted as provided in paragraph (1) shall not lose any vested rights or other benefits the applicant acquired through any provisions of law, including, without limitation, the Subdivision Map Act (Division 2 (commencing with Section 66410) of Title 7 of the Government Code), the Housing Accountability Act (Section 65589.5 of the Government Code), the Builder's Remedy (Chapter 268 of the Statutes of 2024), and the Housing Crisis Act of 2019 (Chapter 12 (commencing with Section 66300) of Division 1 of Title 7 of the Government Code). Vested rights shall relate back to the date any preliminary application pursuant to Section 65941.1 of the Government Code was submitted or the date vesting occurs pursuant to other applicable law.

(4) (A) If an application for an essential project was deemed or determined complete before the effective date of this chapter, the application shall be deemed complete for purposes of this chapter, and a public agency shall not require additional completeness review.

(B) In circumstances where an application has been withdrawn and resubmitted as provided in paragraph (1), any deadlines in this chapter that are triggered by the date an application is determined or deemed to be complete shall be calculated from the time the essential project application is resubmitted by the applicant.

(g) The timelines and deadlines set forth in this chapter shall apply to all essential project applications that are determined or deemed complete, pursuant to Section 21017 or any other law, after the effective date of this chapter irrespective of the date of the application's submission.

(h) Notwithstanding any other law:

(1) If an essential project is a portion or component of a larger project, the portion or component that qualifies as an essential project may be processed, reviewed, and approved pursuant to this chapter.

(2) If the whole of a project is an essential project, the essential project may be implemented in multiple phases, and phased applications are not required to individually meet the criteria for an essential project to be processed, reviewed, and approved pursuant to this chapter.

(i) Unless otherwise stated in this chapter, nothing in this chapter shall be construed to eliminate or restrict a lead agency's discretion to determine an appropriate threshold of significance or mitigation measure in preparing environmental review documents.

(j) Nothing in this chapter prohibits a public agency from imposing a fee upon an applicant, consistent with Articles XIII A and XIII C of the California Constitution, for purposes of covering governmental costs associated with processing and reviewing essential project applications.

(k) An applicant may consent to providing a public agency with additional time to complete environmental review pursuant to Section 21018 or 21019, or to make a decision on other public agency action sought by the applicant pursuant to Section 21023, by agreeing to withhold a written request that the applicant is otherwise entitled to submit pursuant to subdivision (a) of Section 21020 or subdivision (b) of Section 21023.

21015. Interaction with Other Laws

(a) In order to maximize the ability to streamline and speed up approval of essential projects, an applicant may elect to utilize none, some, or all of the provisions of this chapter, and may do so in combination with, or as alternatives to, other land use and environmental review laws, mechanisms, or procedures. Nothing in this chapter either (1) prohibits an applicant from availing itself of other land use and environmental review laws that would provide for more expeditious or advantageous review and approval of essential projects compared to this chapter or (2) requires an applicant seeking approval of a project that meets the definition of an essential project to utilize this chapter.

(b) To the extent that an ambiguity arises regarding how this chapter might operate in conjunction with other provisions of law, the policies and intent set forth in Section 21029 shall control.

(c) The following provisions shall apply to an essential housing project:

(1) The prevailing wage provisions of paragraph (8) of subdivision (a) of Section 65913.4 of the Government Code shall apply solely to buildings over 85 feet in height above grade in any essential housing project.

(2) The provisions of paragraphs (3) and (5) of subdivision (d) of Section 21080.66, as added by Section 59 of Chapter 22 of the Statutes of 2025 (Assembly Bill 130), shall apply to an essential housing project that utilizes this chapter.

(3) (A) In addition to a direct contractor or subcontractor, the provisions of Section 218.9 of the Labor Code shall extend to the owner of an essential housing project during construction of the essential housing project that utilizes this chapter.

(B) For purposes of this paragraph, "owner" means an owner as defined in subdivision (e) of Section 8182 of the Civil Code.

(d) Notwithstanding subdivision (a):

(1) All essential projects that utilize this chapter shall comply with the requirements set forth in Section 21016 pertaining to initial screening and tribal consultation.

(2) With the exception of essential housing projects, all essential projects that utilize this chapter shall comply with the requirements set forth in Section 21028 pertaining to applying the labor requirements described in Section 21183.5 to essential projects.

(3) (A) Except as provided in subparagraph (B), all essential housing projects that utilize this chapter shall comply with the requirements set forth in subdivision (c) pertaining to wages and labor standards on essential housing projects.

(B) If an essential housing project applicant chooses to proceed in part pursuant to this chapter, and in part pursuant to another voluntary streamlined environmental review processing law codified outside of this chapter that also requires the use of either prevailing wages or a project labor agreement, the applicant is required to comply with whatever prevailing wage or project labor agreement requirements are mandated by the other streamlining law for essential project components that are processed and approved pursuant to that other streamlining law.

Article 3. Initial Screening, Tribal Consultation, and Completeness of Essential Project Applications

21016. Tribal Cultural Resources: Initial Screening and Tribal Consultation on Essential Projects

(a) Purpose. The people of the State of California hereby declare that this section is necessary in order to provide for early and meaningful tribal consultation as a key element of essential project planning while maintaining protections for tribal cultural resources. Consulting tribes have knowledge and expertise concerning tribal cultural resources located within essential project areas.

(b) Construction and Interpretation.

(1) Notwithstanding Section 21015 or any other provision of law, the tribal consultation process for essential projects shall follow the provisions set forth in this section.

(2) Nothing in this chapter is intended to alter or conflict with federal government-to-government consultation obligations involving consulting tribes.

(3) The timelines established in Article 4 (commencing with Section 21018) shall not alter the duration of consultation with a consulting tribe on an essential project pursuant to Sections 21080.3.1 and 21080.3.2.

(4) If any technical studies are conducted for the essential project that inform analysis, measures or treatment of tribal cultural resources, consulting tribes shall be afforded the opportunity to review and provide input on those studies.

(5) When provided by a consulting tribe, tribal traditional knowledge shall be incorporated in the identification, treatment, and protection measures concerning tribal cultural resources. As tribal cultural resources is a separate category from cultural resources and archaeological resources, some archaeological methods and standards may not be appropriate for tribal cultural resources. If the lead agency elects not to utilize tribal methods and standards or tribal traditional knowledge, it shall explain its decision in the environmental documents for the essential project, supported by substantial evidence.

(6) All information regarding tribal cultural resources and tribal traditional knowledge disclosed by a consulting tribe shall remain confidential consistent with subdivision (c) of Section 21082.3, and that information shall not be disclosed in the administrative record of proceedings without the permission of the consulting tribe. Lead agencies shall, in consultation

with affected consulting tribes, determine appropriate measures to maintain confidentiality of information regarding tribal cultural resources and tribal traditional knowledge, including, but not limited to, redaction of precise locations, restricted mapping, secure data storage, or other protective handling of tribal cultural resources information. Any written explanation under paragraph (5) of subdivision (c) shall not be subject to challenge to the extent the lead agency does not have permission from the consulting tribe to disclose supporting information due to the confidentiality requirements of this paragraph.

(7) Completion of the initial screening process pursuant to subdivision (c) operates separately from, and does not modify, pause, or affect, any requirements or timelines set forth in Section 21017 or any other provisions of this division.

(c) Initial screening. Upon the applicant's submittal of a preliminary application pursuant to any other law, the applicant's written notice pursuant to subdivision (b) of Section 21024, or an application for an essential project, an early screening to identify and evaluate tribal cultural resources shall take place. An initial screening means the act of participating in early discussions, before an application is determined complete by the lead agency, through a meet and confer process between the consulting tribe, lead agency, and applicant regarding the potential effects a proposed essential project could have on tribal cultural resources. As part of the initial screening process, all of the following shall occur:

(1) (A) An applicant shall provide the lead agency with the following existing information:

(i) A description of the proposed essential project.

(ii) A conceptual site map showing the proposed footprint, alignment, or general boundaries of the project area.

(iii) A vicinity map identifying major landmarks, roadways, and natural features.

(iv) Any geotechnical, environmental, and site-specific technical studies previously developed to support meeting and conferring pursuant to paragraph (4) on early design, routing, or feasibility analysis relating to or affecting tribal cultural resources.

(v) For linear projects such as electric transmission lines, pipelines, rail lines, aqueducts, communications lines, and roads, applicants shall include the general corridor and the location of any starting and ending facilities or substations.

(B) Applicants shall not be required to produce new studies or analyses for the purposes of this subdivision. Any input pursuant to this section other than regarding the identification of tribal cultural resources shall be provided during the tribal consultation process pursuant to subdivision (d).

(2) Within 20 days of receiving the information described in paragraph (1), the lead agency shall complete a records search for recorded and documented archaeological resources, cultural resources, and tribal cultural resources within the proposed project area and the area of potential effects (APE), as that term is defined under Section 800.16 of Title 36 of the Code of Federal Regulations, as determined by the lead agency, through all of the following:

(A) The Sacred Lands File maintained by the Native American Heritage Commission.

(B) The California Historical Resources Information System (CHRIS) maintained by the State Office of Historic Preservation.

(C) The lead agency's records.

(3) Upon completing the search required by paragraph (2), the lead agency shall provide consulting tribes all information obtained pursuant to paragraphs (1) and (2), as well as an invitation to meet and confer pursuant to paragraph (4).

(4) After receiving the information provided by the lead agency pursuant to paragraph (3) and upon the request of a consulting tribe, the consulting tribe, lead agency, and applicant shall meet and confer regarding the proposed essential project and any known or recorded tribal cultural resources, and a consulting tribe may share any information, including information in tribal government registers. During the meet and confer, the three parties shall identify and evaluate treatment and protection methods, measures, and conditions to address impacts on tribal cultural resources, including avoidance and preservation in place. Unless otherwise agreed upon by all parties, any agreements among all the parties from the meet and confer shall be finalized during the tribal consultation process set forth in subdivision (d). The results of the meet and confer shall be documented and maintained by the lead agency in agreement with the consulting tribe.

(5) (A) If a consulting tribe does not respond to the initial screening invitation provided by the lead agency pursuant to paragraph (3) within 30 days, the initial screening process pursuant to this subdivision shall be deemed to have concluded and the parties shall move into the tribal consultation process set forth in subdivision (d). A consulting tribe's decision not to meet and confer under the initial screening process in this subdivision shall in no way affect the consulting tribe's ability or right to participate in the tribal consultation process set forth in subdivision (d).

(B) The initial screening process provided in this subdivision shall end when the tribal consultation process set forth in subdivision (d) begins.

(C) Where the tribal consultation process set forth in subdivision (d) does not apply, the initial screening process under this subdivision shall terminate upon the date of the parties' agreement from the meet and confer pursuant to paragraph (4) or 30 days from the date an application for an essential project is determined complete by the lead agency or deemed complete by operation of law, whichever occurs first.

(d) Tribal consultation. Tribal consultation for an essential project shall be conducted pursuant to Sections 21074, 21080.3.1, 21080.3.2, 21082.3, 21084.2, and 21084.3, except as modified as follows:

(1) The purpose of tribal consultation is to identify tribal cultural resources and evaluate treatment and protection measures for those tribal cultural resources, including the implementation of treatment and protection measures.

(2) Tribal consultation is not meaningful if the consulting tribe is not provided with reasonably requested technical information, including, but not limited to, project information and constraints, data, maps, and information concerning project activities as they relate to treatment and protection of tribal cultural resources. During tribal consultation pursuant to this subdivision, the lead agency shall engage in iterative discussions with the consulting tribe regarding the development of mitigation measures related to tribal cultural resources, including preliminary concepts or approaches before publication of any draft environmental document. This includes notifying the consulting tribe of any existing technical studies or reports in the lead agency's possession that relate to tribal cultural resources on or in the vicinity of the essential project site, to the extent permitted by applicable confidentiality laws, and providing the consulting tribe with access to those studies or reports. To the extent any draft environmental review document is provided to the applicant for review in advance of the public comment period for that environmental review document, the draft shall also be made available to the consulting tribe at the time it is provided to the applicant. Nothing in this section shall be construed to require the lead agency to prepare or circulate draft environmental review documents for purposes of tribal consultation.

(3) Where the lead agency, a consulting tribe, and the applicant agree in writing to measures to avoid or mitigate a significant effect on a tribal cultural resource, those measures and any written agreement shall become enforceable conditions of project approval, subject to the confidentiality requirements under paragraph (6) of subdivision (b).

(e) Treatment and protection of tribal cultural resources. When feasible, damaging effects to any tribal cultural resources shall be avoided. Consistent with subdivision (b) of Section 21014, nothing in this subdivision alters the lead agency's obligation under CEQA to avoid or mitigate significant impacts to tribal cultural resources when feasible. Mitigation and treatment measures adopted in consultation with the consulting tribe pursuant to this subdivision to avoid or minimize significant impacts to tribal cultural resources shall be consistent with the following:

(1) Avoidance and preservation in place shall be considered when requested by the consulting tribe. A tribal cultural resource may be avoided or preserved in place through project design, buffering, or other protective measures to avoid the tribal cultural resources and protect the cultural and natural context, or planning greenspace, parks, or other open space to incorporate the tribal cultural resources with culturally appropriate protection and management criteria referenced in the project's environmental documents.

(2) If an essential project has the potential to cause a substantial adverse change in the significance of a tribal cultural resource, and avoidance and preservation in place are not feasible, the lead agency shall demonstrate and document the basis for that determination with substantial evidence, and the consulting tribe may identify culturally appropriate mitigation measures that the lead agency shall consider and incorporate, to the extent feasible, in developing mitigation and treatment measures in a manner consistent with paragraph (2) of subdivision (b) of Section 21084.3.

(3) When an essential project proposes construction-related ground disturbance activities and when requested by the consulting tribe, the lead agency shall include inadvertent discovery measures to reduce significant impacts to tribal cultural resources. Those measures may include procedures for temporary halts of grading, identification and assessment protocols, timing provisions, and additional treatment methods or protective measures.

(f) Essential project approval. A lead agency may only approve an essential project pursuant to this section when all of the following apply:

(1) Tribal consultation has concluded in good faith.

(2) Where there is agreement among all parties pursuant to either paragraph (4) of subdivision (c) or subdivision (d), any agreed upon mitigation and avoidance measures are included as enforceable project conditions.

(3) If avoidance and preservation in place is not feasible, the lead agency has demonstrated and documented the basis for that determination with substantial evidence and incorporated other measures to minimize impacts consistent with CEQA.

21017. Determining Completeness of Essential Project Applications

(a) (1) When a public agency receives an initial application for an essential project, the public agency shall review the application, make a written finding whether the application is complete, and notify the applicant in writing of the determination.

(2) The written determination of completeness for an initial application shall be made within 30 days of the public agency's receipt of the initial application. If the public agency fails to provide a determination of completeness within 30 days, then the initial application shall be deemed complete for the purposes of this division.

(3) An application shall not be determined to be incomplete on the basis of (A) informational or analytical studies or documents that were not required by the public agency in a written, publicly available submittal requirement checklist or similar document in existence at the time the initial application was

submitted or (B) statutes, regulations, rules, standards, or ordinances that are not existing laws.

(b) If the public agency's determination of completeness finds that the initial application for an essential project is incomplete, at the time that finding is made the public agency shall also provide the applicant with an exhaustive written corrections list containing thorough descriptions of the items and specific information, or lack thereof, that led to the finding of incompleteness.

(c) (1) (A) The applicant shall, within 90 days of a notification that its initial application is incomplete, submit additional information or a revised application that addresses the matters identified on the written corrections list.

(B) If the applicant cannot comply with the 90-day deadline in subparagraph (A) to submit either additional information or a revised application, the applicant shall notify the public agency in writing why it is unable to do so and include an estimate of when it will be able to do so.

(2) Upon any submission of supplemental information or a revised application, the public agency shall determine if the supplemented submittal is complete based only on the written corrections list provided by the agency pursuant to subdivision (b). The public agency shall provide a determination of completeness based upon the supplemented submittal within 30 days of receipt thereof. If the public agency finds that the supplemented submittal is still incomplete, at the time that finding is made the public agency shall provide the applicant with an updated exhaustive written corrections list. The updated written corrections list may only contain items included on the written corrections list provided in response to the applicant's initial application.

(3) If a supplemented submittal is again deemed incomplete, the applicant may submit additional rounds of supplemental information or revised applications pursuant to the procedures and timelines set forth in this subdivision.

(4) If the public agency fails to provide a determination of completeness within 30 days of receiving either supplemental information or a revised application pursuant to paragraph (2) or (3), the application shall be deemed complete for purposes of this division.

(5) A public agency shall not request or require an applicant to provide any new information unless that information was included on the exhaustive written corrections list for the immediately prior version of the application.

(d) (1) A determination of completeness finding that an initial application, supplemented application, or revised application is incomplete shall be appealable by the applicant to the public agency's planning commission, planning director, or other official with final authority over application completeness. If the public agency does not have a planning commission, planning director, or other official with final authority over application completeness, then the appeal shall be heard by the highest-ranking elected or appointed decisionmaking body or official of the agency. There shall be a final written determination on the appeal not later than 60 days after receipt of the applicant's written appeal.

(2) If the final written determination on the appeal is not made within the 60-day period described in paragraph (1), the application shall be deemed complete for the purposes of this division.

(e) The applicant may bring a civil action challenging an adverse determination under subdivision (d). Any action shall be commenced within 90 days of an adverse final written determination issued pursuant to subdivision (d).

Article 4. Review of Completed Applications for Essential Projects

21018. Local Agency Timeline for Completing Environmental Review of Essential Projects

(a) A local agency that is acting as a lead agency (local lead agency) for an application or approval of an essential project shall decide whether the project is subject to subdivision (b), (c), or (d) within 30 days of the essential project application being determined or deemed to be complete pursuant to Section 21017, or deemed complete pursuant to any other law, whichever occurs first.

(b) Essential projects that require an environmental impact report. For essential projects that require an environmental impact report, the local lead agency shall make a final determination whether to certify an environmental impact report no later than 365 days after the essential project application being determined or deemed to be complete pursuant to Section 21017, or deemed complete pursuant to any other law, whichever occurs first.

(c) Essential projects that require a negative declaration or mitigated negative declaration. For essential projects that require a negative declaration or mitigated negative declaration, the local lead agency shall make a final determination whether to adopt a negative declaration or mitigated negative declaration no later than 180 days after the essential project application being determined or deemed to be complete pursuant to Section 21017, or deemed complete pursuant to any other law, whichever occurs first.

(d) For all other environmental review documentation prepared pursuant to this division for an application or approval of an essential project, the local lead agency shall, within 90 days after the essential project application being determined or deemed to be complete pursuant to Section 21017 or deemed complete pursuant to any other law, whichever occurs first, make a final determination that the essential project is exempt from this division or that the essential project's impacts were previously evaluated under a prior environmental review document pursuant to, without limitation, Section 21083.3 or 21094.5, or an addendum pursuant to Section 15162 or 15164 of Title 14 of the California Code of Regulations.

(e) The deadlines set forth in subdivisions (b), (c), and (d) shall be extended upon written request from the applicant.

21019. Timeline for Completing Environmental Review of Essential Projects by Public Agencies That Are Not Local Agencies

(a) A public agency other than a local agency that is acting as a lead agency (nonlocal lead agency) for an essential project shall decide whether the project is subject to subdivision (b), (c), or (d) within 30 days of the essential project application being determined or deemed to be complete pursuant to Section 21017, or deemed complete pursuant to any other law, whichever occurs first.

(b) Essential projects that require an environmental impact report. For essential projects that require an environmental impact report, the nonlocal lead agency shall make a final determination whether to certify an environmental impact report no later than 365 days after the essential project application being determined or deemed to be complete pursuant to Section 21017, or deemed complete pursuant to any other law, whichever occurs first.

(c) Essential projects that require a negative declaration or mitigated negative declaration. For essential projects that require a negative declaration or mitigated negative declaration, the nonlocal lead agency shall make a final determination whether to adopt a negative declaration or mitigated negative declaration no later than 180 days after the essential project application being determined or deemed to be complete pursuant to Section 21017, or deemed complete pursuant to any other law, whichever occurs first.

(d) For all other environmental review documentation prepared pursuant to this division for an application or approval of an essential project, the nonlocal lead agency shall, within 90 days after the essential project application being determined or deemed to be complete pursuant to Section 21017 or deemed complete pursuant to any other law, whichever occurs first, make a final determination that the essential project is exempt from this division or that the essential project's impacts were previously evaluated under a prior environmental review document pursuant to, without limitation, Section 21083.3 or 21094.5, or an addendum pursuant to Section 15162 or 15164 of Title 14 of the California Code of Regulations.

(e) The deadlines set forth in subdivisions (b), (c), and (d) shall be extended upon written request from the applicant.

21020. Noncompliance with Timelines for Completing Environmental Review of Essential Projects

(a) When a local lead agency or a nonlocal lead agency fails to comply with a deadline set forth in subdivisions (b) to (d), inclusive, of Section 21018, or subdivisions (b) to (d), inclusive, of Section 21019, the applicant may make a written request for the agency to hold a meeting or hearing on the essential project as provided in this section.

(b) Within 60 days of receipt of a written request pursuant to subdivision (a), the local lead agency or nonlocal lead agency shall do all of the following:

(1) Complete all environmental review documentation for the essential project or assemble available environmental review documentation, including any applicant-prepared environmental review document as is allowed pursuant to subdivision (b) of Section 21082.1 or any other law.

(2) Hold a meeting or hearing on the essential project application as follows:

(A) If the agency has a multimember decisionmaking body subject to the Bagley-Keene Open Meeting Act (Article 9 (commencing with Section 11120) of Chapter 1 of Part 1 of Division 3 of Title 2 of the Government Code), the Ralph M. Brown Act (Chapter 9 (commencing with Section 54950) of Part 1 of Division 2 of Title 5 of the Government Code), or similar open meeting law, the agency shall place the essential project on its agenda for a regular or special meeting of the agency's highest-ranking decisionmaking body.

(B) If the agency does not have a multimember decisionmaking body subject to the Bagley-Keene Open Meeting Act, the Ralph M. Brown Act, or a similar open meeting law, then the highest-ranking official of the agency, or their designee, shall hold a hearing with the applicant on the essential project.

(3) Notwithstanding any other provision of this division or any other law, at the meeting or hearing described in paragraph (2), the agency shall do both of the following:

(A) Make a final written determination on the available environmental review documentation that has been completed as of the date of the meeting or hearing.

(B) Make a final written determination to approve or disapprove the essential project.

(c) (1) If the local lead agency or nonlocal lead agency has a planning commission or planning director, upon receipt of a written request pursuant to subdivision (a), the planning commission or planning director shall hold a regular or special meeting for the purpose of providing a recommendation on the essential project.

(2) The meeting of the planning commission or planning director described in this subdivision shall occur within 30 days of receipt of a written request pursuant to subdivision (a).

(3) Any environmental review documentation needed for the meeting described in this subdivision shall be completed in advance of the date of the meeting as required by law.

(d) The deadlines set forth in subdivisions (b) and (c) shall only be extended upon a written request made by the applicant.

(e) Except as provided in subdivision (f), a local lead agency and a nonlocal lead agency have a nondiscretionary ministerial duty to comply with the

deadlines set forth in this section or in any written request made pursuant to subdivision (d) and complete the actions described in paragraph (3) of subdivision (b).

(f) If, before the expiration of the 60-day period provided in subdivision (b), the agency completes all environmental documentation for the essential project and issues a final written determination to approve the essential project, the agency and the applicant may mutually agree in writing to cancel the meeting or hearing on the essential project required by paragraph (2) of subdivision (b).

(g) (1) An action under this division may be brought by the applicant challenging either of the following:

(A) The agency's failure to comply with its nondiscretionary ministerial duties described in subdivision (e).

(B) The agency's denial or imposition of unlawful conditions of approval on an essential project.

(2) The action shall be commenced within 90 days of the agency's failure, denial, or imposition described in paragraph (1).

(h) Notwithstanding any other provision of this section, Section 21018, or Section 21019, where the lead agency for an essential project is also the applicant for that essential project, the lead agency may extend any deadline contained in this section, Section 21018, or Section 21019 through a written notice that specifies the duration of the extension and the reason for it. The notice shall be posted on the lead agency's internet website and included in the administrative record.

21021. Timeline for Public Comments on Essential Projects

(a) A public agency shall circulate an environmental review document for an essential project for public comment periods as follows:

(1) Twenty days for a negative declaration or mitigated negative declaration or other document requiring public circulation under state law.

(2) Forty-five days for a draft environmental impact report or subsequent or supplemental environmental impact report.

(b) A public comment period described in subdivision (a) shall not be tolled or extended except by a court of competent jurisdiction.

(c) If a public agency continues any public hearing on an essential project, or the CEQA review of that essential project, the public agency shall continue the hearing to a date certain and, upon approval of the continuance, close the public comment period. The public agency shall not reopen the public comment period at any subsequent hearing on the essential project.

(d) (1) Notwithstanding any other law, only the following comments shall be included in the administrative record for an essential project:

(A) Electronic and written comments received during the public comment periods set forth in subdivision (a).

(B) For CEQA determinations with no comment period set forth in subdivision (a), electronic and written comments received at least 48 hours before a public hearing or noticed decision on the environmental review documentation for the essential project.

(C) (i) For hearings or appeals of a CEQA determination, electronic and written comments received at least 48 hours before a public hearing on issues that could not have been raised during the public comment period set forth in subdivision (a) because of significant changes to the essential project that precluded the issue from being raised during the public comment period, or new information that was not known and could not have been known during the public comment period.

(ii) "Significant changes to the essential project" shall not include any changes to an essential project made in response to public comment, through the CEQA alternatives review process, or through lead agency concerns identified during the CEQA process.

(D) Oral testimony at a noticed and recorded public hearing.

(2) All other public comments shall be disregarded and excluded from the administrative record.

(e) Notwithstanding any other law, a response by the lead agency or applicant to a comment described in paragraph (1) of subdivision (d), or comments from the applicant in response to a question from a public agency or to demonstrate the essential project's compliance with this division, shall, without qualification, be included in the administrative record for an essential project.

21022. Determination of Impacts

Notwithstanding any other law:

(a) (1) A public agency considering whether to approve an essential project shall identify, evaluate, determine significance, and mitigate the impacts of an essential project based on compliance with existing laws.

(2) To the extent a public agency has published, adopted, or routinely used thresholds of significance for environmental effects of essential projects on the date a preapplication or an application for an essential project is filed, whichever occurs first, an applicant may elect to vest into those thresholds of significance, in which case the public agency shall use them in determining the significance of the essential project's environmental effects.

(b) An essential project's compliance with this division and the state CEQA Guidelines shall be based solely upon the project's compliance with subdivision (b) of Section 21029.

(c) An applicant may waive the application of one or both of subdivision (a) or (b) to an essential project by submitting a written request for a waiver to the public agency.

21023. Other Public Agency Actions for Essential Projects

(a) If an essential project requires any other public agency action that is not expressly addressed by other provisions of this chapter, the public agency shall make a final written decision based on compliance with existing laws. The final written decision on the other public agency action shall be completed as follows:

(1) Where a public agency is a lead agency for an essential project, the public agency shall make the final decision concurrently with its certification of the environmental impact report, adoption of a negative declaration or mitigated negative declaration, or determination of previous evaluation or exemption from this division, as applicable.

(2) A state lead agency may delay the final decision required by paragraph (1) by up to 90 days if all of the following apply:

(A) Before December 31, 2025, the state agency had an established process set forth in statute or regulation for conducting evidentiary hearings on the type of public agency action being sought for the essential project.

(B) Before the deadline set forth in paragraph (1), the state agency provides written notice to the applicant that it will go forward with an evidentiary hearing.

(3) Where an applicant seeks an approval for an essential project from a public agency that was not a lead agency for that essential project during the first instance when the essential project underwent environmental review pursuant to this division, that public agency shall make a final written decision before the later of (A) 90 days from the date the application for the public agency action was determined or deemed to be complete pursuant to Section 21017, or deemed complete pursuant to any other law, whichever occurs first, or (B) one day has passed from the date the lead agency approved the project.

(b) When a public agency fails to comply with a deadline set forth in subdivision (a), the applicant may make a written request for the public agency to hold a meeting or hearing on the other public agency action sought from the public agency.

(c) Within 45 days of receipt of a written request pursuant to subdivision (b), the public agency shall do all of the following:

(1) Hold a meeting or hearing on the essential project application as follows:

(A) If the public agency has a multimember decisionmaking body subject to the Bagley-Keene Open Meeting Act (Article 9 (commencing with Section 11120) of Chapter 1 of Part 1 of Division 3 of Title 2 of the Government Code), the Ralph M. Brown Act (Chapter 9 (commencing with Section 54950) of Part 1 of Division 2 of Title 5 of the Government Code), or similar open meeting law, the public agency shall place the other agency action sought from the public agency on its agenda for a regular or special meeting of the agency's highest-ranking decisionmaking body.

(B) If the public agency does not have a multimember decisionmaking body subject to the Bagley-Keene Open Meeting Act, the Ralph M. Brown Act, or similar open meeting law, the highest-ranking official of the public agency, or their designee, shall hold a hearing with the applicant on the other public agency action sought by the applicant.

(2) Notwithstanding any other provision of this division or any other law, at the meeting or hearing described in paragraph (1), the public agency shall make a final written decision to grant or deny the other public agency action sought by the applicant.

(d) The deadlines set forth in subdivisions (a) and (c) shall only be extended upon a written request made by the applicant.

(e) Except as provided in subdivision (f), a public agency has a nondiscretionary ministerial duty to comply with the deadlines set forth in this section or in any written request pursuant to subdivision (d) and make the decision described in paragraph (2) of subdivision (c).

(f) If, before the expiration of the 45-day period provided in subdivision (c), the public agency makes a final written determination to grant the other public agency action sought for the essential project, the public agency and the applicant may mutually agree in writing to cancel the meeting or hearing required by paragraph (1) of subdivision (c).

(g) (1) An applicant may bring an action under this division challenging both of the following:

(A) The agency's failure to comply with its nondiscretionary ministerial duties described in subdivision (e).

(B) The agency's denial or imposition of unlawful conditions of approval on the other public agency action sought from the public agency.

(2) The action shall be commenced within 90 days of the agency's failure, denial, or imposition described in paragraph (1).

Article 5. Preliminary Scoping Process and Streamlined Alternatives Analysis for Essential Projects

21024. Preliminary Scoping Process for Essential Projects

(a) An applicant may, but is not required to, utilize the preliminary scoping process and streamlined alternatives analysis as provided in this article. However, where an applicant voluntarily chooses to utilize this preliminary scoping process and streamlined alternatives analysis, it shall comply with this article.

(b) (1) Before submitting an application for an essential project, an applicant that chooses to proceed in accordance with this article shall provide written notice to the lead agency of its intent to complete the scoping process and streamlined alternatives analysis set forth in this article.

(2) The written notice shall present a preliminary overview and description of the proposed essential project sufficient to inform the lead agency and the public of the anticipated features of the project. The written notice is not required to include detailed

Living in SPACE

by Judy Nayer



CHAPTER 7 WORKING AND PLAYING

Jobs that are easy on Earth can be much harder in space. Have you ever tried to fix something, wearing five layers of gloves? Every day the astronauts have a long list of jobs to do. They conduct experiments, clean the spacecraft, and repair broken parts.

Astronaut Bonnie Dunbar checks an experiment on the space shuttle *Endeavor.*



What work do astronauts do in space?

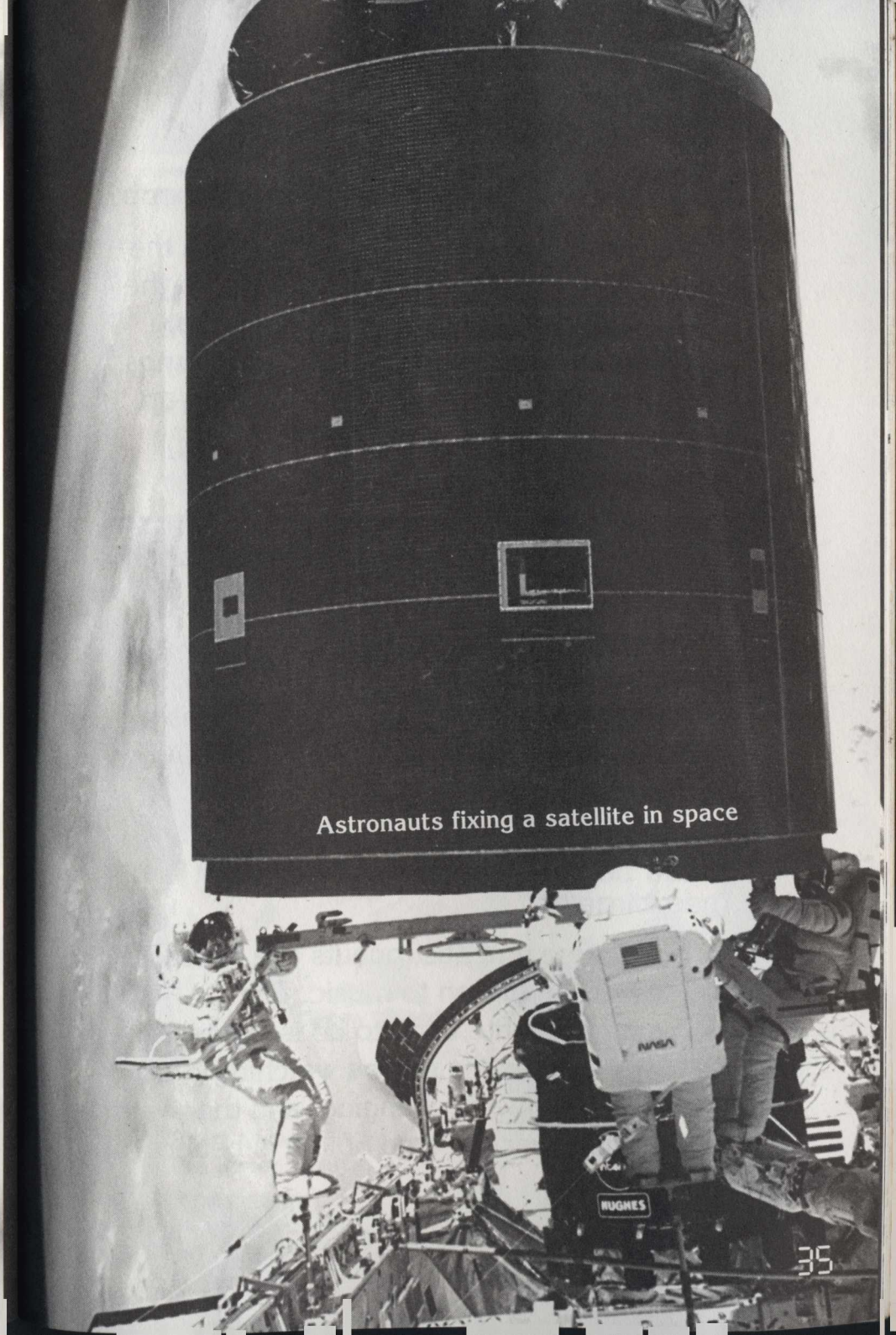
Often, astronauts are sent into space to put satellites into orbit. They also fix satellites already in space. Different kinds of satellites do different jobs. For example, weather satellites take pictures of clouds and storms. Some satellites send television signals. Others help ships and planes find their way.

What experiments do astronauts do in space?

Astronauts do many kinds of experiments. They use telescopes to watch the stars and the earth. They use cameras to take pictures that help us learn about the earth.

Do astronauts make things in space?

Yes. Some metals can be melted together in space but not on Earth. These metals are used in making parts for airplanes and machines. Crystals grow much better in space. Crystals are used in cameras, telescopes, and computers.



Astronauts fixing a satellite in space

Do astronauts have to clean in space?

Yes! Every day they have to vacuum the filters that keep the air clean and polish the computers. Astronauts also have to dust with a special cloth. Dust, hair, and crumbs are everywhere. They must be cleaned up, or the air will get dirty and equipment could break.

Do astronauts have to take out the garbage in space?

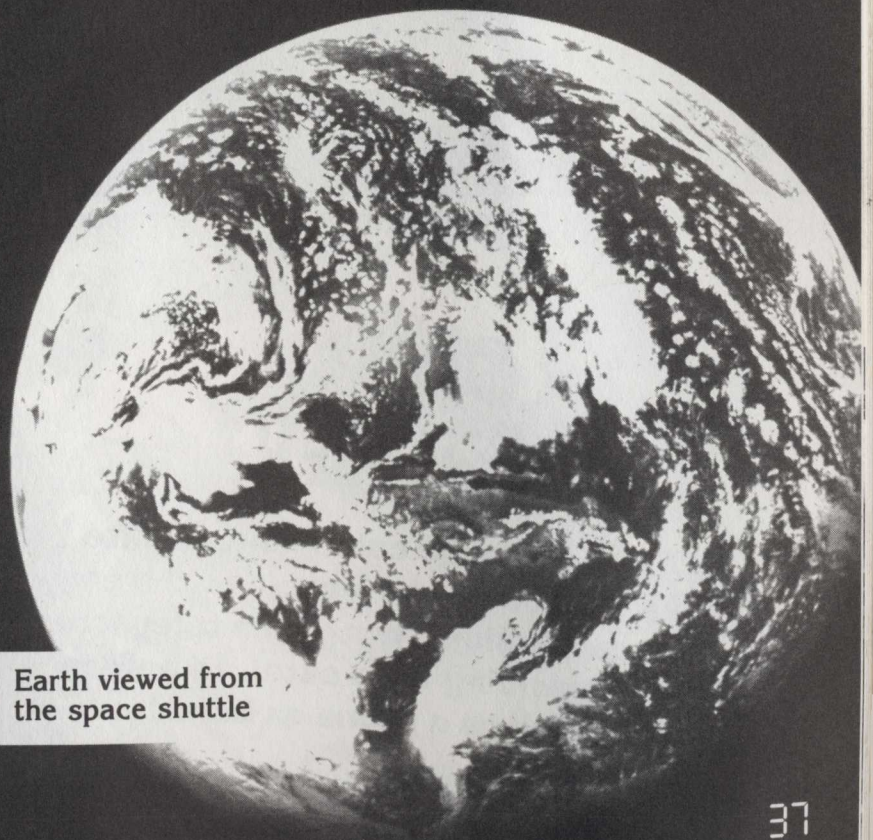
If garbage were taken out in space, it would stay in orbit for years! All of the garbage is put into plastic bags. The trash is put in a special area and then taken back to Earth.

What do astronauts do in their free time?

In their free time, astronauts like to read, play cards, and listen to music. The astronauts' favorite thing to do is sightsee. Sightseeing in space means watching Earth. The scene is always changing, and the astronauts never get tired of it. It is better than TV!

What do astronauts see from space?

The astronauts have a beautiful view of Earth. They see blue oceans, orange deserts, and brown mountains. They see ice in the Antarctic Ocean and volcanoes in Hawaii. They see swirling clouds and flashes of lightning. They see a bright white sun, the moon, the stars, and the lights of big cities.



Earth viewed from the space shuttle